



Building a Better World
for All of Us®



MEETING MINUTES

RE: Mower County Comprehensive Plan
Planning Advisory Committee Meeting #3

Date of Meeting: February 13, 2025

Project Manager: Nate Day

Time of Meeting: 5:30 to 7:00 P.M.

SEH No.: 180253

Location of Meeting: Elkton Community Center
Virtual

The following items were discussed at the above-referenced meeting (see attached presentation for additional reference):

- **Introductions**
- **Schedule and Milestones**
 - Overall project/PAC schedule was reviewed, as well as what has been accomplished thus far (including the work by the Velocity Group)
- **Review of the Draft Vision Statement**
 - Original vision statement was “too wordy”
 - Vision Statements from other counties were cited as examples (see the end of this document).
 - Suggestions to include in the final statement include:
 - focusing on sustainability
 - regenerative practices
 - the well-being of all residents.
- **Review of Demographic Analysis and Employment Trends**
 - Discussed
 - Employment
 - Age Distribution
 - Ethnicity and Race
 - Housing
 - Industries
 - Questions were asked about the definition of a job as well as how many individuals have multiple jobs. Please see the write up at the end of these minutes.
- **Phase 2 Public Engagement**
 - Summary Open House on January 15
 - Discussed results from prioritization exercise and opinions on public utilities and services.
 - Virtual Open House
 - For those who could not make the in-person event, a virtual open house is available on the project website: www.compplan2045.com/open-house
 - The virtual option includes all the information that was shared at the in-person open house
 - Online surveys #2
 - The second online surveys are live and can be accessed via the project website.
 - These surveys are a lot longer and ask in-depth questions regarding all the topics covered in the comprehensive plans

- Public input will be key in developing goals, strategies, and policies for each plan element.
 - 59 responses.
 - Discussion on how to reach more residents. Ideas include:
 - Postcards with survey/project information
 - Attend High School sporting event.
- **Sustainable Development and Resiliency**
 - Project team provided Oxford dictionary definitions of sustainability and resiliency.
 - PAC members were asked to participate in a Menti exercise to reflect how sustainability and resiliency has shown up in Austin (reference attached Menti sheets to read all the responses)
 - What does sustainability and resilience mean for your community?
 - To make sure we continue to grow in a way that is supportive, not destructive. To provide resources that help people achieve their goals - life goals and career goals.
 - It means we will strive to increase the average incomes to boost quality of life.
 - Ensuring current actions are not short-sighted and negatively affect our future and those that come after us. Prepared to withstand and/or quickly recover from economic, weather and other forces.
 - It means the community can adapt to expected, and unexpected changes or circumstances.
 - Having an economic base that is able to flex and endure, thrive and survive, the rise and fall of the world's needs and demands and needs.
 - What have been examples where Mower County has been resilient?
 - *No responses*
 - How can the new Comprehensive Plan support Mower County being more resilient and sustainable?
 - We need healthy people who have a good quality of life - that should be the base goal for this county plan.
- **Next Steps**
 - Next PAC Meeting: TBD via [Doodle](#)

If changes or additions are needed in this document, or if relevant information has been omitted, please contact Project Manager, Nate Day at nday@sehinc.com.

Responses to questions asked during the demographic portion of the meeting

For the question regarding how is a "Job Defined":

The U.S. Census Bureau defines employment based on an individual's work activity during a specified reference period, regardless of the form of compensation or tax documentation. According to the Bureau's guidelines, individuals are considered employed if they:

- Worked during any part of the survey week as paid employees;
- Worked in their own business, profession, or farm;
- Worked 15 hours or more as unpaid workers in a family-owned enterprise;
- Not working but had jobs or businesses from which they were temporarily absent due to illness, bad weather, vacation, labor-management dispute, or personal reasons, whether they were seeking another job.

This definition encompasses various forms of employment, including traditional W-2 employees, self-employed individuals, gig workers, freelancers, and those engaged in cash-only jobs, provided they report working for pay or profit during the reference period. The classification does not require the presence of tax forms.
US Census Bureau

For the question regarding the number of individuals with more than one job:

Using the US Census Bureau's LEHD On the Map program I was able to look at employment in Mower County using 2022 Longitudinal Employer-Household Dynamics data (LEHD).

- All Jobs: 15,225
- Total Primary Jobs: 14,062
- Total Private Jobs: 12,844
- Total Private Primary Jobs: 11,848

"Primary Jobs" means the jobs where only an individual's highest earning job is counted. While I cannot give you a breakdown of how many individuals hold two jobs, how many hold three jobs etc., this data does show that there are **1,163 jobs** that are not someone's primary job.

"Private Jobs" are jobs in the private sector.

The following map is from the OnTheMap program that displays job density information in a "Heat Map" format. OnTheMap is a unique tool that provides insight on job movement and employment demographics. For those interested you can follow the link below to the website where you can adjust settings yourself to give you a better picture on employment within Mower County.

<https://onthemap.ces.census.gov/>

COMPREHENSIVE
PLAN
2045



Planning Advisory Committee (PAC) Meeting #3

February 13, 2025



Agenda

- **Re-Introductions**
- **Project Schedule**
- **Draft Vision Statement**
- **Demographic Analysis**
- **Community Engagement**
- **Sustainability**
- **Next Steps**





Your Team Today



Nate Day
Lead Senior Planner
(County)



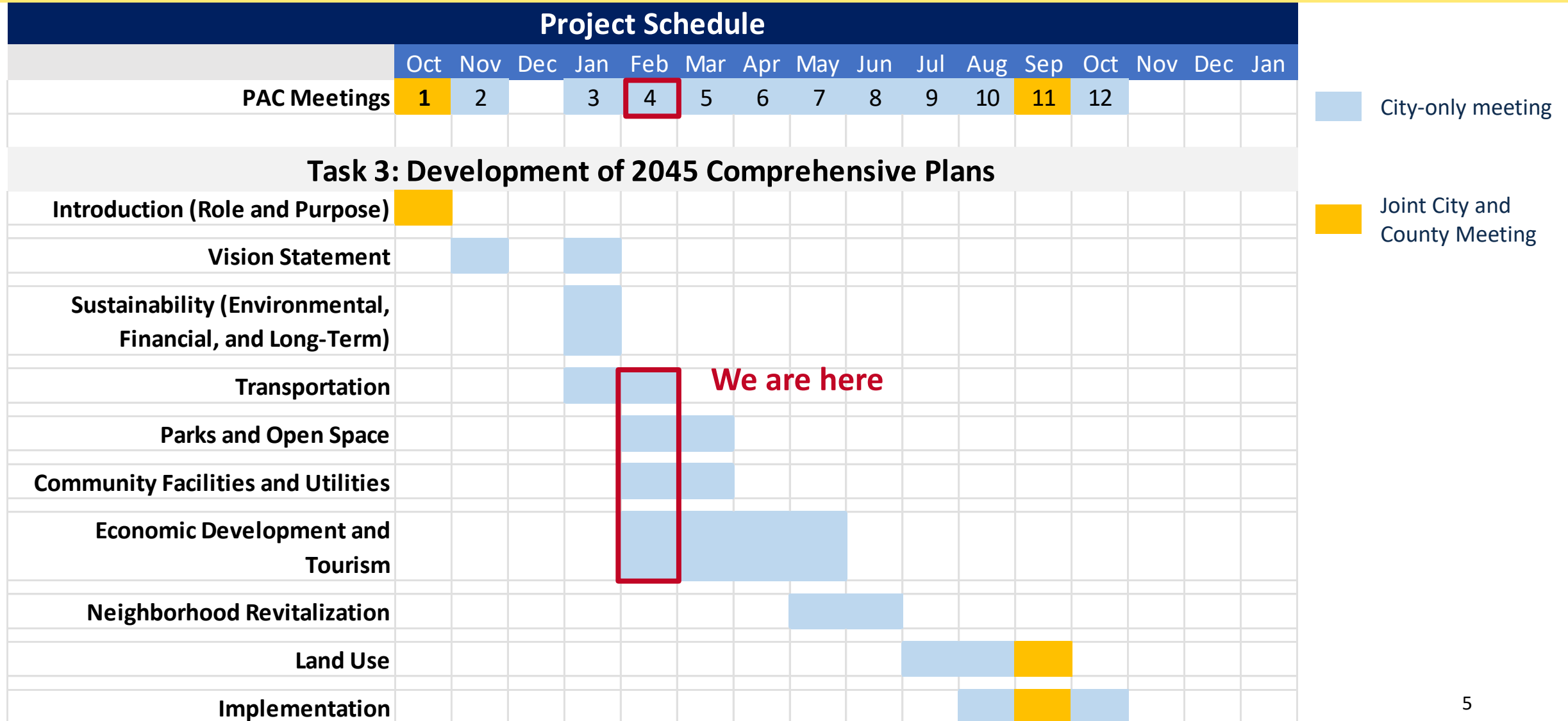
Brian Murphy
Planner and GIS Specialist



Schedule and Milestones



Schedule and Milestones





Visit #4: February 17-21



Karin Endy
food.agriculture.education.health

URBAN3

Velocity group

ZEITGEIST CONSULTING

DMO PROZ

CIVI TAS



COMPREHENSIVE PLAN 2045

MOWER COUNTY | CITY OF AUSTIN

Community Workshop + Presentation Schedule

• Feb 17

- (3:30-5:00p) - **Downtown District Council (DC): City Center**
 - *Historic Hormel Home, 208 4th Ave NW*

• Feb 18

- (11:30a-1p) - **Community of Practice (CoP): Education**
 - *Riverland Community College - East Building - C110, 1600 8th Ave NW*
- (3:00-5:00p) **CoP: Activation**
 - *Launch, 401 Main St N #202*
- (6:30pm) - **Urban3 City/County Economic Presentation**
 - *Austin City Council Chambers, 500 4th Ave NE*

• Feb 19

- (5:15p) - **Civitas Presentation - Parks, Recreation, and Forestry Board Meeting**
 - *Jay C. Hormel Nature Center, 1304 21st St NE*

• Feb 20

- (8-9:30a) - **CoP: Arts and Culture**
 - *Launch, 401 Main St N #202*
- (11a-1p) **CoP: Brand and Story**
 - *Launch, 401 Main St N #202*

• Feb 21

- (9-10:30a) - **DC: Oakland Ave Corridor**
 - *Launch, 401 Main St N #202*
- (Noon-2p) - **CoP: Access and Equity**
 - *Launch, 401 Main St N #202*
- (3:30-5p) - **DC: 4th Ave Corridor**
 - *Launch, 401 Main St N #202*
- (5:30p) - **Community Planning Happy Hour**
 - *B&J Bar and Grill, 14 4th Ave NE*



Draft Vision Statement



Draft Vision Statement

The following draft vision statement is based on public input and those developed by PAC members at the December 18th kickoff meeting:

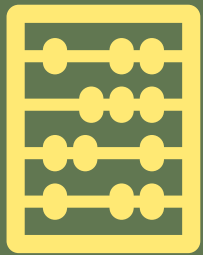
“Mower County envisions itself as a vibrant, thriving community that blends its rich agricultural heritage with modern amenities and sustainable practices. Our friendly neighborhoods, connected by well-maintained roads and bike-friendly trails, offer a welcoming environment for all. We celebrate our diverse culture through festivals and community events, fostering a sense of pride and belonging. Together, we build a community that values sustainability and the well-being of all its residents.”



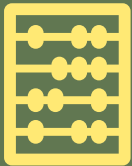
Draft Vision Statement: Version 2

The following draft vision statement is based on public input from the Open House on January 15, 2025:

“Mower County blends its agricultural heritage with modern amenities, offering welcoming towns, connected roads and trails, and vibrant cultural events that enhance community well-being.”



Demographic Analysis and Employment Trends



Demographic Analysis and Employment Trends

Demographic and Employment Trends Report includes:

- Population growth projections
- Age distribution
- Income
- Race and ethnicity
- Employment and industry
- Commuting patterns
- Job growth projections
- Housing characteristics

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Short Elliot Hendrickson

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- o Residential building permit data by type of housing to the most current available figures (data to be provided by City of Austin and Mower County) compared to SE Region
- o U.S. Census and American Community Survey (ACS) findings collected between 2010 and 2022 (or most current data) on housing units by structure type and tenure
- o Data on owner-occupied housing units by estimated value

Population and Household Growth Trends

The 2010 and 2020 figures are from the U.S. Census while the 2024 to 2045 projections are provided by Maxfield Research.

	POPULATION GROWTH TRENDS AND PROJECTIONS PRIMARY MARKET AREA					
	Historical		Projections		Projections	
	2010	2020	2024	2030	2040	2045
Population						
Austin	24,945	36,274	36,400	36,875	37,525	37,775
Mower County	33,185	42,021	40,725	41,875	43,155	43,680
SE Region	434,584	517,852	523,258	538,023	553,307	556,342
Change	1,515,576	1,178,424	1,177,291	1,177,105	1,177,105	1,177,291
Household						
Austin	10,131	13,228	13,300	13,369	13,470	13,485
Mower County	13,400	16,581	16,815	16,880	17,041	17,145
SE Region	171,990	205,711	205,795	205,801	205,801	205,801
Change	2,087,527	2,023,880	2,023,880	2,023,880	2,023,880	2,023,880
Persons Per Household						
Austin	2.46	2.56	2.56	2.56	2.56	2.56
Mower County	2.47	2.55	2.54	2.54	2.54	2.54
SE Region	2.55	2.52	2.54	2.54	2.54	2.54
Change	2.54	2.55	2.52	2.52	2.52	2.52

Sources: Maxfield Research and Consulting, BLS, Mower County Data Analytics Center

- Between 2010 and 2020, Austin grew by 5.1% in population and 1.0% in households. Mower County grew by 2.2% in population and lost -0.8% in households.
- The City of Austin is projected to increase by 201 people (2.7%) and 133 households (1.3%) between 2020 and 2030. Mower County is anticipated to grow by 1,846 people (5.5%) and 133 households (0.8%) between 2020 and 2030.

MAXFIELD RESEARCH AND CONSULTING

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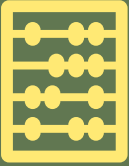
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Household Income

	HOUSEHOLD INCOME BY AGE OF HOUSEHOLDER CITY OF AUSTIN 2014 to 2030							
	Age of Householder							
	Total	<25	25-34	35-44	45-54	55-64	65-74	75+
2014								
Less than \$15,000	799	10	95	94	83	136	119	218
\$15,000 to \$24,999	741	34	90	80	86	87	128	207
\$25,000 to \$34,999	708	89	114	77	58	175	156	189
\$35,000 to \$49,999	1,502	30	230	240	179	208	287	259
\$50,000 to \$74,999	1,966	85	118	304	377	352	341	275
\$75,000 to \$99,999	1,707	51	254	362	303	300	275	161
\$100,000 to \$149,999	1,756	49	368	448	348	284	175	145
\$150,000 to \$199,999	601	7	73	100	115	187	98	88
\$200,000 or more	481	2	48	129	124	98	55	24
Total	10,350	409	1,567	1,899	1,657	1,896	1,586	1,540
Median Income	\$45,888	\$47,232	\$48,100	\$48,738	\$49,381	\$49,239	\$48,083	\$48,935
2030								
Less than \$15,000	710	48	83	77	58	160	104	211
\$15,000 to \$24,999	611	27	77	57	42	57	105	246
\$25,000 to \$34,999	858	12	93	58	51	93	137	191
\$35,000 to \$49,999	1,388	72	238	209	148	162	237	203
\$50,000 to \$74,999	1,914	79	295	264	344	301	362	269
\$75,000 to \$99,999	1,783	54	262	350	310	287	215	145
\$100,000 to \$149,999	1,851	57	374	514	410	318	222	205
\$150,000 to \$199,999	849	2	105	215	176	346	101	102
\$200,000 or more	562	2	42	117	151	109	71	39
Total	10,540	378	1,590	1,890	1,699	1,879	1,679	1,748
Median Income	\$75,143	\$52,285	\$75,740	\$93,138	\$88,978	\$79,700	\$63,146	\$44,938
Change 2014 - 2030								
Less than \$15,000	-89	38	-12	-17	-25	-76	-15	-10
\$15,000 to \$24,999	-130	-8	-22	-22	-34	-29	-24	-11
\$25,000 to \$34,999	-112	-8	-21	-18	-26	-32	-19	-2
\$35,000 to \$49,999	-134	-18	-21	-31	-31	-46	-10	-24
\$50,000 to \$74,999	-42	-6	-71	-39	-78	-51	-71	-44
\$75,000 to \$99,999	77	8	6	-6	7	-13	38	33
\$100,000 to \$149,999	345	8	68	67	62	33	47	60
\$150,000 to \$199,999	247	0	34	50	51	39	13	41
\$200,000 or more	61	0	18	8	27	11	15	8
Total	210	-35	22	-9	42	-120	92	206
Median Income	\$10,244	\$5,053	\$11,300	\$9,404	\$9,517	\$10,481	\$6,881	\$5,013

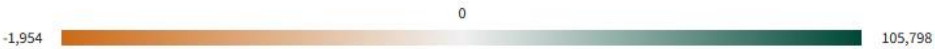
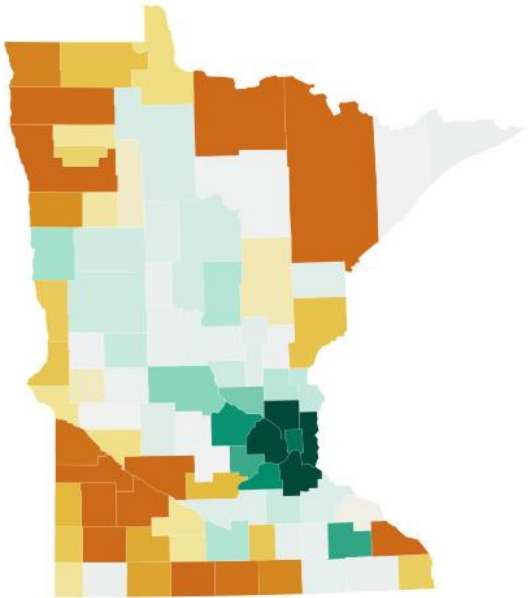
Sources: ERI, US Census Bureau, Maxfield Research & Consulting

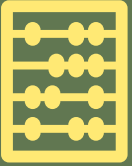
MAXFIELD RESEARCH AND CONSULTING



Population Projections

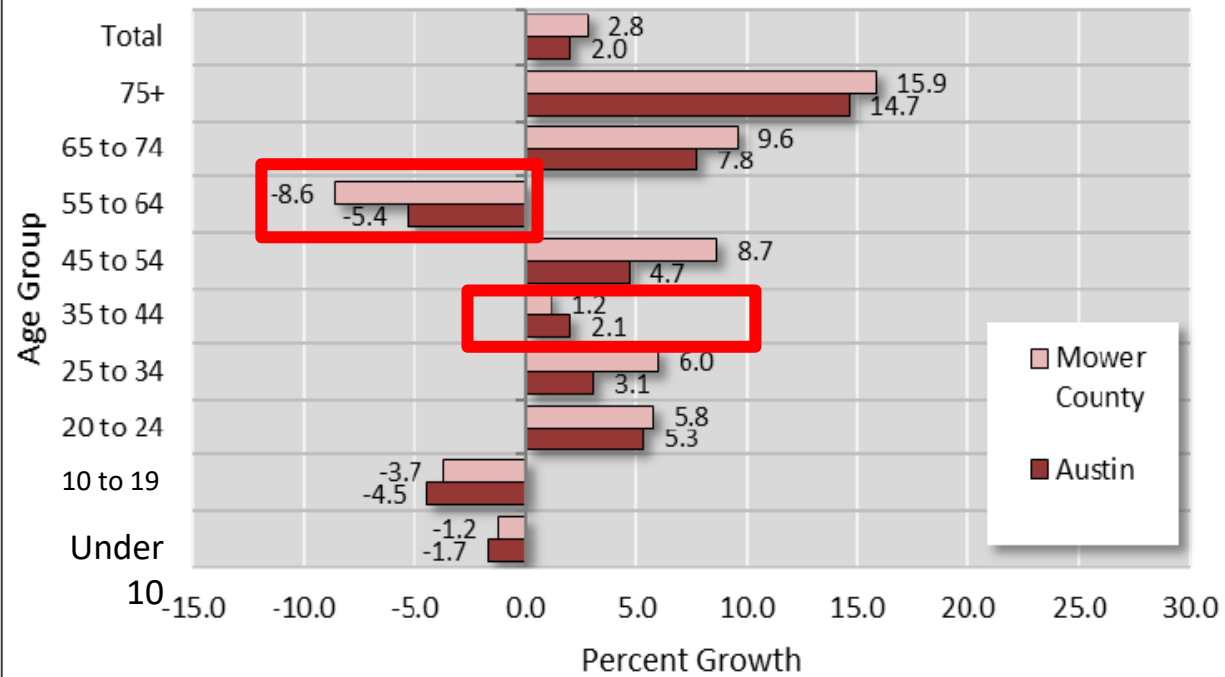
POPULATION GROWTH TRENDS AND PROJECTIONS										
PRIMARY MARKET AREA										
2010 - 2045										
	Historic		Estimate	Forecast			Change			
	2010	2020	Estimate	Projection	Projection	Projection	2010 - 2020		2020 - 2030	
			2024	2030	2040	2045	No.	Pct.	No.	Pct.
Population										
Austin	24,915	26,174	26,430	26,875	27,525	27,775	1,259	5.1%	701	2.7%
Mower County	39,163	40,029	40,725	41,875	43,155	43,660	866	2.2%	1,846	4.5%
SE Region	494,684	517,852	525,268	538,625	553,307	556,942	23,168	4.7%	20,773	4.0%
Minnesota	5,303,925	5,706,494	5,777,995	5,923,535	6,082,629	6,121,397	402,569	7.6%	217,041	3.8%
Households										
Austin	10,131	10,228	10,350	10,560	10,870	10,985	97	1.0%	332	3.2%
Mower County	15,828	15,700	16,015	16,500	17,035	17,245	-128	-0.8%	800	5.0%
SE Region	193,690	205,311	209,000	215,000	221,000	224,000	11,621	6.0%	9,689	4.6%
Minnesota	2,087,227	2,253,990	2,295,000	2,350,000	2,420,000	2,450,000	166,763	8.0%	96,010	4.2%
Persons Per Household										
Austin	2.46	2.56	2.55	2.54	2.53	2.53				
Mower County	2.47	2.55	2.54	2.54	2.53	2.53				
SE Region	2.55	2.52	2.51	2.51	2.50	2.49				
Minnesota	2.54	2.53	2.52	2.52	2.51	2.50				
Sources: Maxfield Research and Consulting; Esri; MN State Demographic Center										





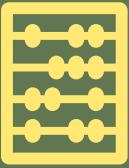
Age Groups

Projected Population Growth by Age Group: 2024-2030



POPULATION AGE DISTRIBUTION
AUSTIN, MOWER COUNTY, SE REGION, and MINNESOTA
2010 - 2030

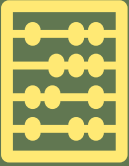
Age					Change			
	Census		Estimate	Projection	2010-2024		2024-2030	
	2010	2020	2024	2030	No.	Pct.	No.	Pct.
Lower County								
Under-10	5,609	5,414	5,523	5,454	-86	-1.5	-69	-1.2
10 to 19	5,251	5,837	5,777	5,564	526	10.0	-213	-3.7
20 to 24	2,184	2,102	2,428	2,568	244	11.2	140	5.8
25 to 34	4,710	4,842	4,700	4,980	-10	-0.2	280	6.0
35 to 44	4,479	4,893	5,246	5,307	767	17.1	61	1.2
45 to 54	5,522	4,411	4,423	4,806	-1,099	-19.9	383	8.7
55 to 64	4,590	5,144	4,775	4,364	185	4.0	-411	-8.6
65 to 74	2,874	4,009	4,271	4,680	1,397	48.6	410	9.6
75+	3,944	3,377	3,583	4,151	-361	-9.2	568	15.9
Total	39,163	40,029	40,725	41,875	1,562	4.0	1,150	2.8



Housing

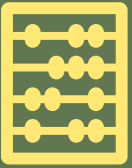
TENURE BY HOUSEHOLD SIZE MARKET AREA 2010 & 2024									
HH Size		City of Austin				Mower County			
		2010		2024		2010		2024	
		No.	Pct.	No.	Pct.	No.	Pct.	No.	Pct.
1-Person	Own	1,860	55.0	1,547	48.0	2,813	59.3	2,506	55.3
	Rent	1,524	45.0	1,639	50.8	1,928	40.7	1,995	44.0
	Total	3,384	100	3,224	100	4,741	100	4,533	100
2-Person	Own	2,720	81.7	2,702	79.9	4,752	85.5	4,945	85.6
	Rent	610	18.3	681	20.1	804	14.5	829	14.4
	Total	3,330	100	3,382	100	5,556	100	5,774	100
3-Person	Own	925	70.4	1,128	83.2	1,639	76.7	1,761	84.1
	Rent	388	29.6	228	16.8	499	23.3	333	15.9
	Total	1,313	100	1,356	100	2,138	100	2,093	100
4-Person	Own	766	71.3	917	74.8	1,392	77.3	1,548	80.6
	Rent	309	28.7	308	25.2	409	22.7	372	19.4
	Total	1,075	100	1,226	100	1,801	100	1,920	100
5-Person	Own	399	66.4	540	76.8	712	73.9	849	80.5
	Rent	202	33.6	164	23.2	252	26.1	206	19.5
	Total	601	100	704	100	964	100	1,056	100
6-Person	Own	135	57.4	213	81.0	255	69.7	308	83
	Rent	100	42.6	50	19.0	111	30.3	65	17.4
	Total	235	100	263	100	366	100	372	100
7+Person	Own	97	50	147	64	154	58.8	203	68
	Rent	96	49.7	84	36	108	41.2	95	32
	Total	193	100	231	100	262	100	298	100
TOTAL	Own	6,902	68.1	7,195	69.5	11,717	74.0	12,120	75.7
	Rent	3,229	31.9	3,154	30.5	4,111	26.0	3,894	24.3
	Total	10,131	100	10,349	100	15,828	100	16,014	100
Avg. HH Size	Own	2.41		2.64		2.47		2.59	
	Rent	2.30		2.10		2.27		2.11	

- Percentage of households that are renting have decreased between 2010 and 2024.
- Mower County saw the number of households increase by 186 in the previous 14 years.
 - Household ownership increased by 403
 - City of Austin saw Household ownership increase by 293



Ethnicity and Race

Race/Ethnicity	2010		2024		Change	
	2010-2024					
	No.	Pct.	No.	Pct.	No.	Pct.
City of Austin						
White Alone	21,656	86.9%	17,239	65.2%	-4,417	-20.4%
Black Alone	749	3.0%	1,662	6.3%	913	121.8%
American Indian Alone	79	0.3%	173	0.7%	94	118.7%
Asian Alone	604	2.4%	2,235	8.5%	1,631	270.1%
Pacific Islander Alone	39	0.2%	357	1.3%	318	--
Some Other Race Alone	1,192	4.8%	2,564	9.7%	1,372	115.1%
Two or More Races	596	2.4%	2,201	8.3%	1,605	269.3%
Total	24,915	100%	26,430	100%	1,515	6.1%
Hispanic (ethnicity)	3,804	15.3%	5,024	19.0%	1,220	32.1%
Mower County						
White Alone	35,495	90.6%	30,410	74.7%	-5,085	-14.3%
Black Alone	818	2.1%	1,753	4.3%	935	114.3%
American Indian Alone	97	0.2%	211	0.5%	114	117.9%
Asian Alone	649	1.7%	2,363	5.8%	1,714	264.1%
Pacific Islander Alone	40	0.1%	369	0.9%	329	823.0%
Some Other Race Alone	1,336	3.4%	2,803	6.9%	1,467	109.8%
Two or More Races	728	1.9%	2,815	6.9%	2,087	286.7%
Total	39,163	100%	40,725	100%	1,562	4.0%
Hispanic (ethnicity)	4,138	10.6%	5,609	13.8%	1,471	35.5%

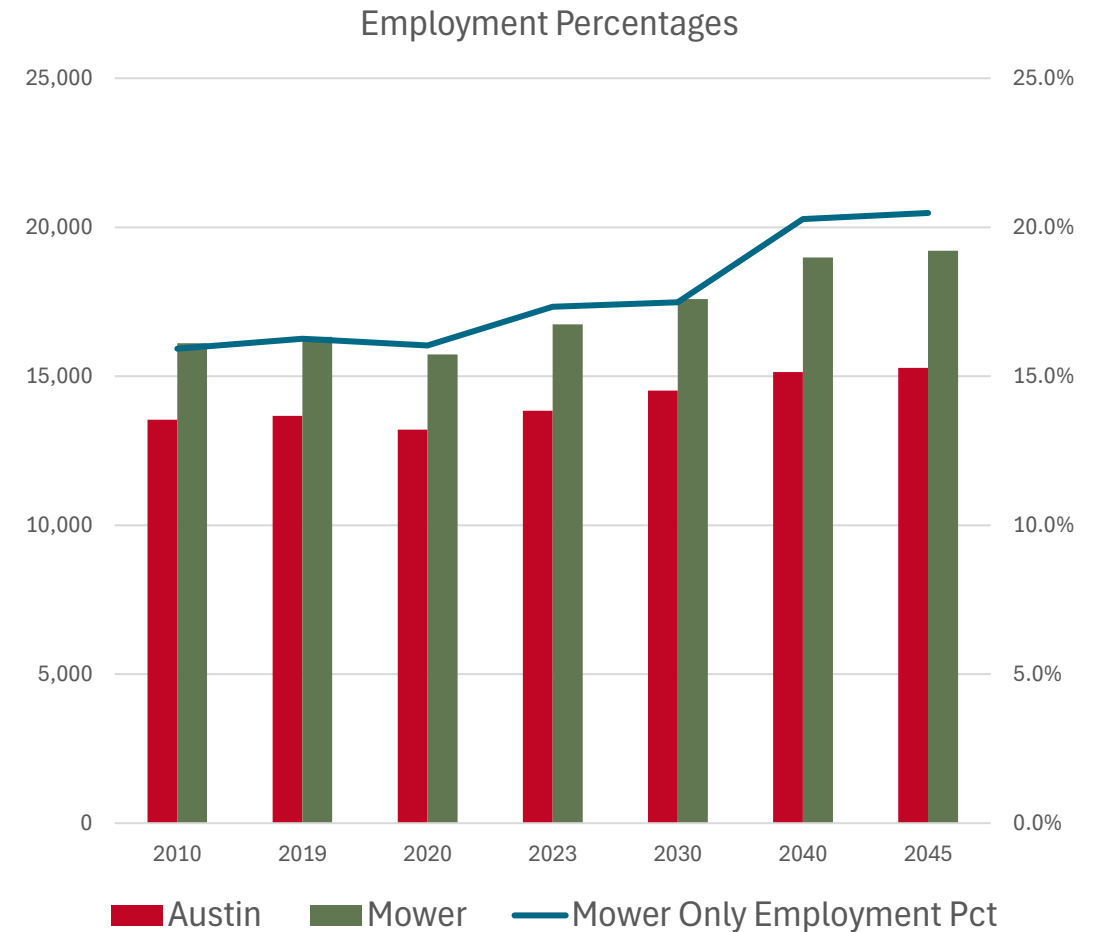


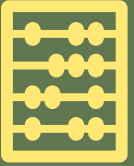
EMPLOYMENT (2024)

Total Jobs in Mower County
16,740

Total Jobs Only in Austin
13,839

**17.3% of jobs are located
outside of Austin**





Austin – Top 5 Industries

1. Manufacturing – 3,742
2. Education & health services – 3,650
3. Trade, transportation, utilities – 2,137
4. Prof. & business services – 1,731
5. Hospitality – 1,183

Mower County – Top 5 Industries

1. Education & health services – 4,413
2. Manufacturing – 3,915
3. Trade, transportation, utilities – 2,996
4. Prof. & business services – 1,959
5. Hospitality – 1,414



Phase 2 Public Engagement



COMPREHENSIVE PLAN 2045

MOWER COUNTY | CITY OF AUSTIN

Open House #1 Summary

January 15, 2025

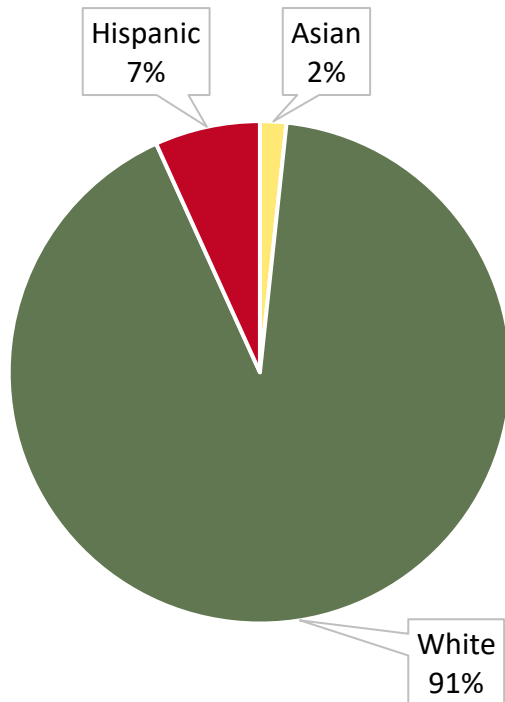


Open House - January 15

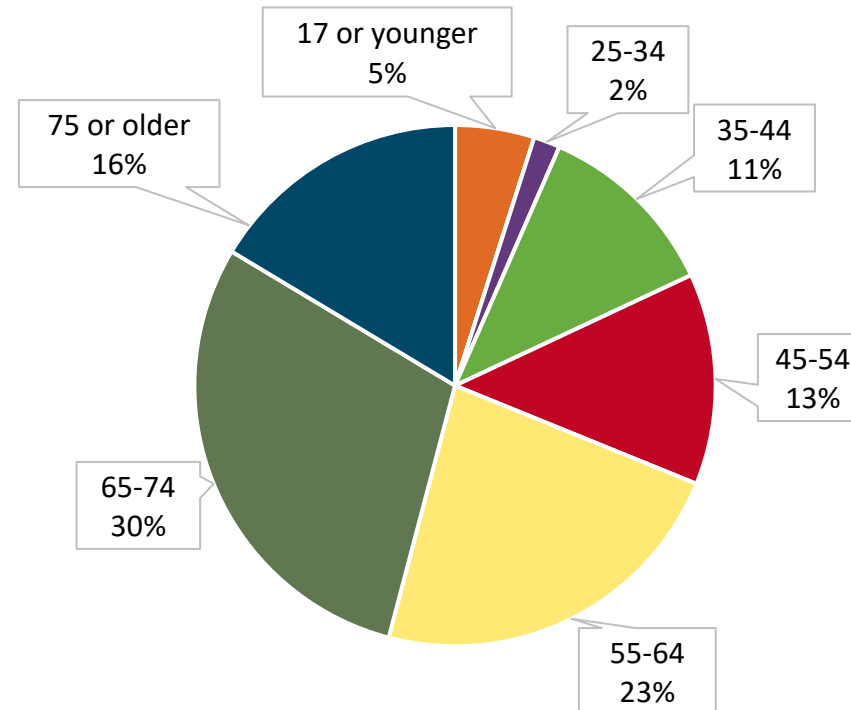


About 79 attendees

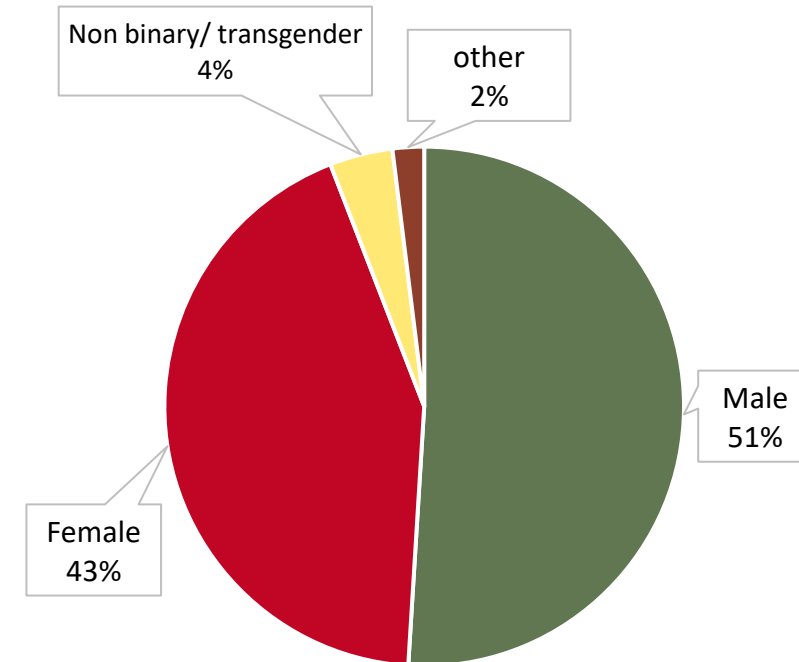
Race/Ethnicity



Age



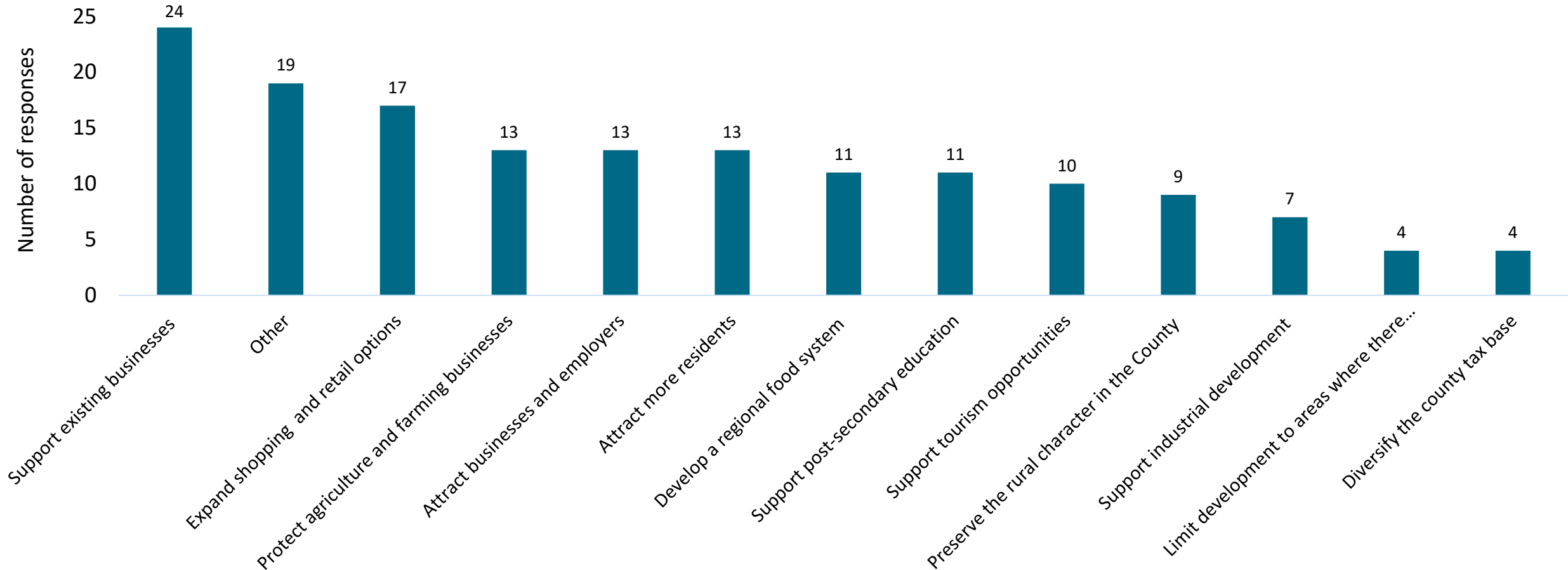
Gender





Open House – Draft Vision

What should be the County's top priorities for the future? (Select top 4 responses)





Open House – Draft Vision

Please indicate to what extent you agree or disagree with each of the following statements about public utilities and services in Mower County?

Category	Strongly agree	Somewhat agree	Neutral	Somewhat disagree	Strongly disagree
Sheriff services are well managed and adequately provided.	4	10	3	4	0
Fire and rescue service are well managed and adequately provided	10	7	2	0	0
Mower County is responsive, respectful and well managed	8	3	5	1	2
There is good cooperation between my community and Mower County	4	6	2	2	5
Broadband and internet services meets my needs	8	0	2	7	5
There are strong measures to reduce or limit flooding events	6	6	5	6	0



Virtual Open House

Did you or someone you know miss the open house? Visit the site below for the recorded presentation and a link to Survey #2

www.compplan2045.com/open-house



The screenshot shows the 'COMPREHENSIVE PLAN 2045' website for Mower County and the City of Austin. The header includes navigation links: ABOUT, The PLANS, NEWS, and ENGAGE. The main content area features a large white box with the heading 'Welcome to the Virtual Open House!'. Below this, text states: 'Can't make the January 15 Open House? No worries, this page has all the information that will be shared at the in-person event for the Mower County and City of Austin Comprehensive Plans.' It then says: 'Watch the recorded introduction presentation below and scroll down to learn more. Don't forget to take the online surveys!'. At the bottom, there is a video player showing a presentation with a play button overlay. To the right of the video is a circular profile picture of Brea Grace, Project Manager (SEH). The video player shows a progress bar at 00:00 / 03:07 and includes volume and settings icons.



Survey #2

Survey #2

- Themes
 - Draft Vision Statement Review
 - Aspect prioritization
 - Parks/Natural Resources
 - Transportation
 - County Infrastructure
 - Housing
 - Taxation
- Current Results
 - 59 responses
 - ¼ of the responses from Survey #1
 - 48 respondents have fully completed the survey

PLAN MOWER COUNTY 2045 - Survey #2

PLAN MOWER COUNTY 2045 - Survey #2

INTRO



PLAN MOWER COUNTY 2045

Mower County has partnered with the City of Austin to develop Comprehensive Plans jointly. This partnership will ensure a unified vision for the City and County into the year 2045. This is the second community survey for this project. Your input will help develop strategic goals, plans, policies, and action steps to guide community growth and deliver important community services.

We want to hear from residents, business and property owners, employees and visitors. Your community knowledge, experience and ideas are needed to ensure the Comprehensive Plan reflects community values.

Please take this short survey to provide your comments.

Mower County se ha asociado con la Ciudad de Austin para desarrollar Planes Maestros de manera conjunta. Esta asociación garantizará una visión unificada para la Ciudad y el Condado hasta el año 2045. Esta es la segunda encuesta para este proyecto. Tus comentarios ayudarán a desarrollar objetivos, planes, políticas y pasos de acción para guiar el crecimiento de Austin y brindar importantes servicios comunitarios.

Queremos escuchar de los residentes, propietarios de negocios y propiedades, empleados, y visitantes. Tu conocimiento y experiencia de tu comunidad son necesarios para garantizar que el Plan refleje los valores de la comunidad.

Por favor, responde esta breve encuesta para proveer tus comentarios.

Next

25%



Sustainable Development



What is Sustainability?

Definition: Capable of being maintained or continued at a certain rate or level. - *Oxford English Dictionary*

What is Resiliency?

Definition: Ability to recover from or adjust easily to adversity or change. - *Meriam Webster*



Triple Bottom Line and Sustainability

1. Economic Sustainability

- Strengthening **agriculture and agribusiness** while diversifying the local economy.
- Supporting **workforce development** in emerging industries like renewable energy or advanced manufacturing.
- Encouraging **local business growth** in Austin and other communities to maintain a strong tax base.
- Investing in **infrastructure improvements** to enhance connectivity and attract investment.

2. Environmental Sustainability

- Addressing **stormwater management** and flood resilience, particularly with increased precipitation patterns.
- Expanding **soil health and conservation programs** for sustainable farming.
- Encouraging **renewable energy projects** like wind and solar to reduce dependency on nonrenewable resources.
- Supporting **preservation of natural spaces** to maintain biodiversity and recreational opportunities.

3. Social Sustainability

- Enhancing **affordable housing options** to support workforce retention and community growth.
- Investing in **transportation accessibility**, including transit and pedestrian-friendly infrastructure.
- Supporting **public health initiatives**, including access to healthcare and active living programs.
- Engaging the **community in planning decisions**, ensuring equitable access to resources and services.



Sustainability and Resiliency Goals and Objectives

Mower County: 2002 Comprehensive Plan

Planning Goals

- Conservation of prime agricultural lands for long-term agricultural use.
- Conservation and enhancement of the County's rich natural resource base.
- Preservation of the rural/small town/agrarian lifestyle in harmony with the urban lifestyle.
- Maintenance of healthful living environments and compatible land use relationships.

Mower  *County*
Comprehensive Plan
2002



What is the role of sustainability and resiliency in Mower County?

Go to: Menti.com
Code: 1988 0712





Next Steps



Next Steps

February 2025

- Sunday, February 16th through Saturday, February 22nd - Velocity Group team's visit
- February 18th (6:30pm- after City Council) - City Council/County Commissioners/Planning Commission Special Meeting – Urban3 Presentation / Workshop
- February 20th (2pm-3:30pm) – County-City TAC Meeting (in-person)

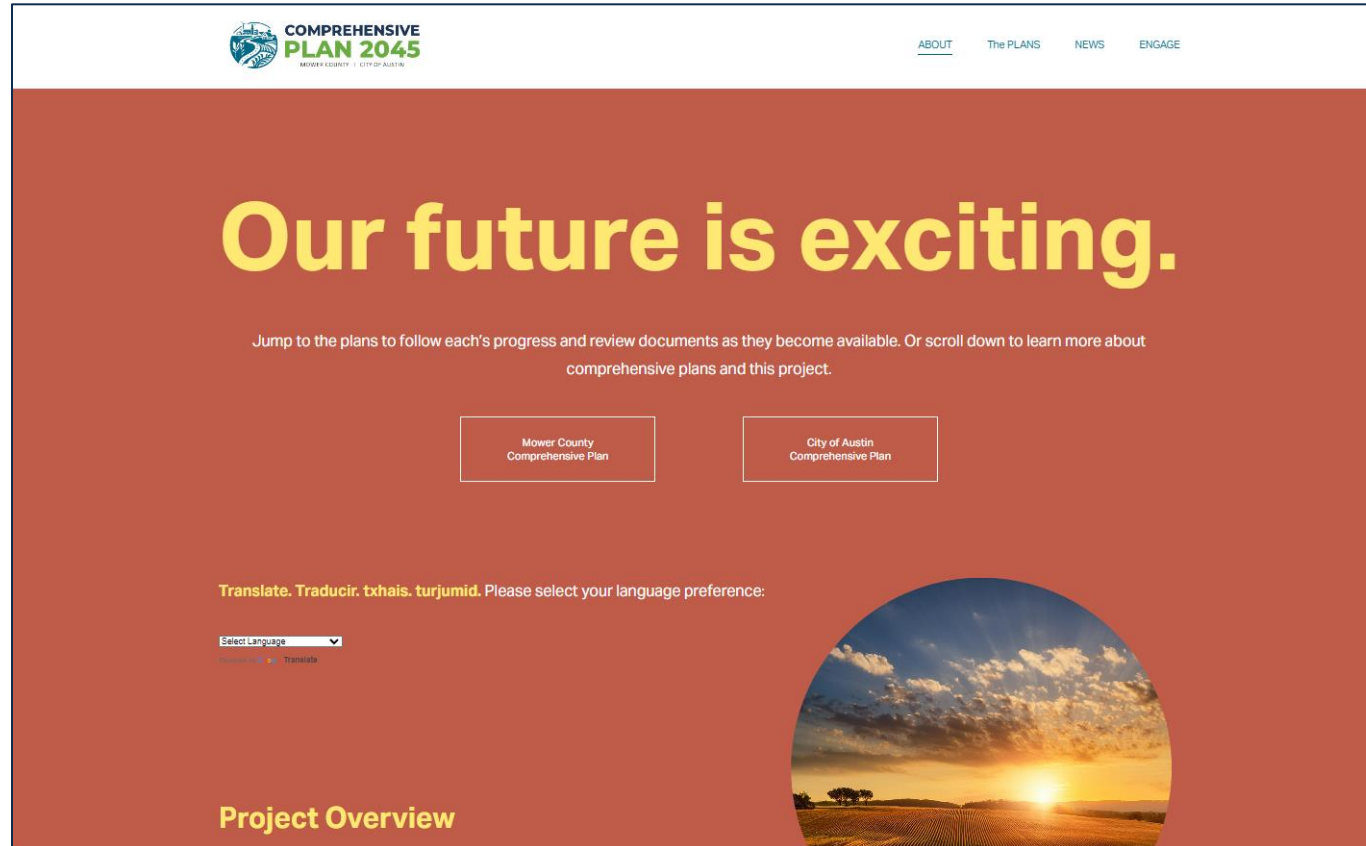
March 2025

- Velocity Group team / Communities of Practice virtual presentation of specialist's work (findings and recommendations)
- End-of March – Specialists submittal of reports/recommendations

Next PAC Meeting: March 20th



For more information



Visit the project website:

<https://www.compplan2045.com/>

A landscape photograph of a sunset over a plowed field. The sun is low on the horizon, casting a warm, golden glow across the sky and the field. The sky is filled with scattered clouds, some of which are illuminated by the sun. The field in the foreground is plowed, showing distinct furrows that lead towards the horizon. In the distance, there are silhouettes of trees and a barn on the left side. The overall scene is peaceful and evokes a sense of hope and planning for the future.

Let's Plan Our Future.